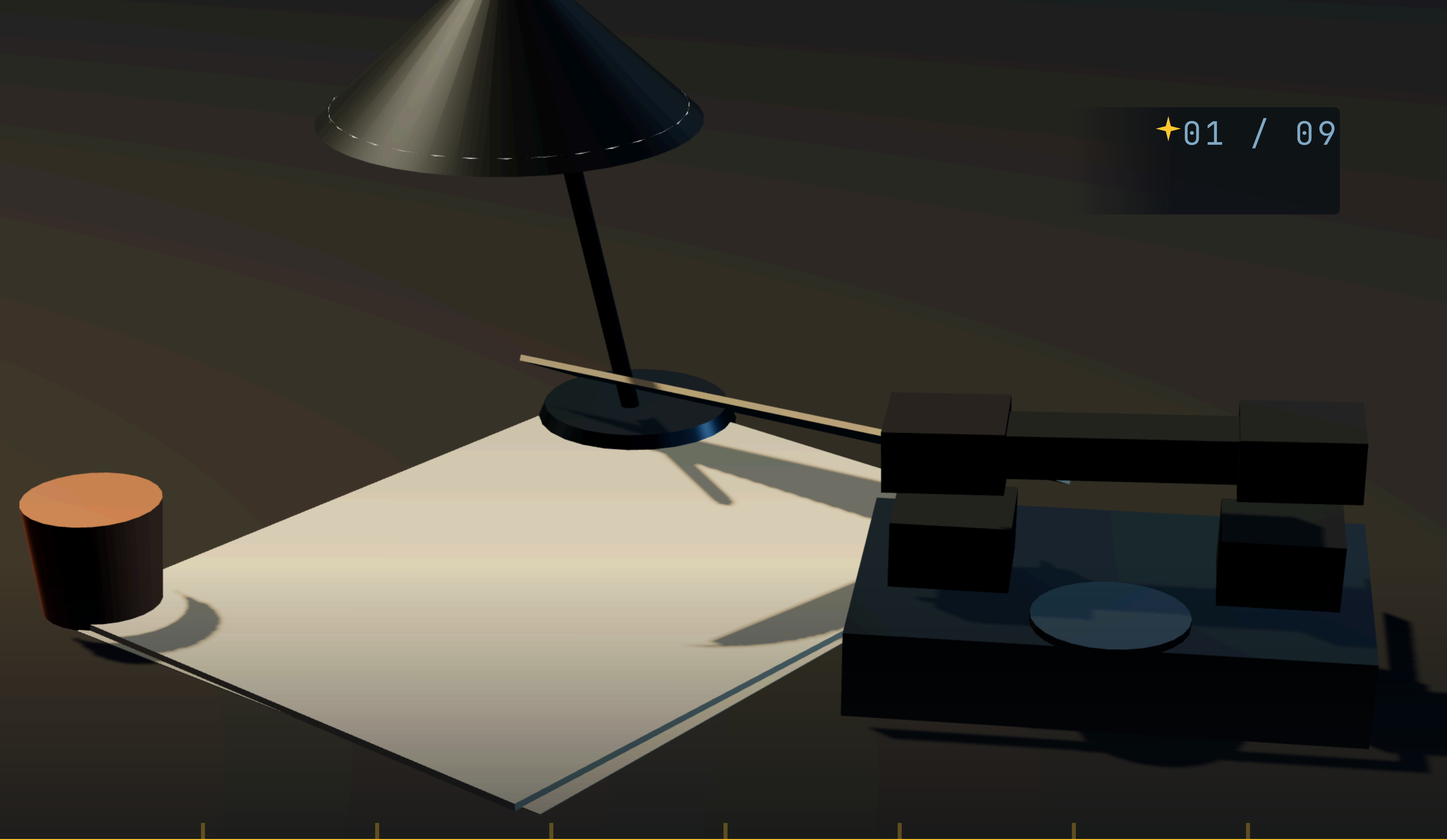


8,000 dollars a month for somebody else to answer the phone.

CASE FILE NO. 002

Akron Ohio. Founded 1958. 200 plus people in the group.

The 8,000 and the headcount are the owner's own figures, said on the podcast he co-hosts

THE COMPANY

They answered their own phones around the clock.

Wilson Plumbing, Heating, Cooling and Electric started in Akron Ohio in 1958, the shop Ralph and Theresa Wilson opened. Third generation runs it now. Over 200 people across the group by the CEO’s own account, spread over more than one location. And they answered their own phones 24 hours a day.

Founding per the company's own site. Headcount by the CEO's own account, and it covers the whole group, not the Akron shop alone.

8,000 dollars a month, on top of the desk they already staffed.

John Wilson answered his own phones around the clock and still paid an outside answering service 8,000 dollars a month. He says the service got worse after it was acquired. "I remember what 8,000 a month was," the owner said on the podcast he co-hosts.

8,000

dollars a month, outside answering service

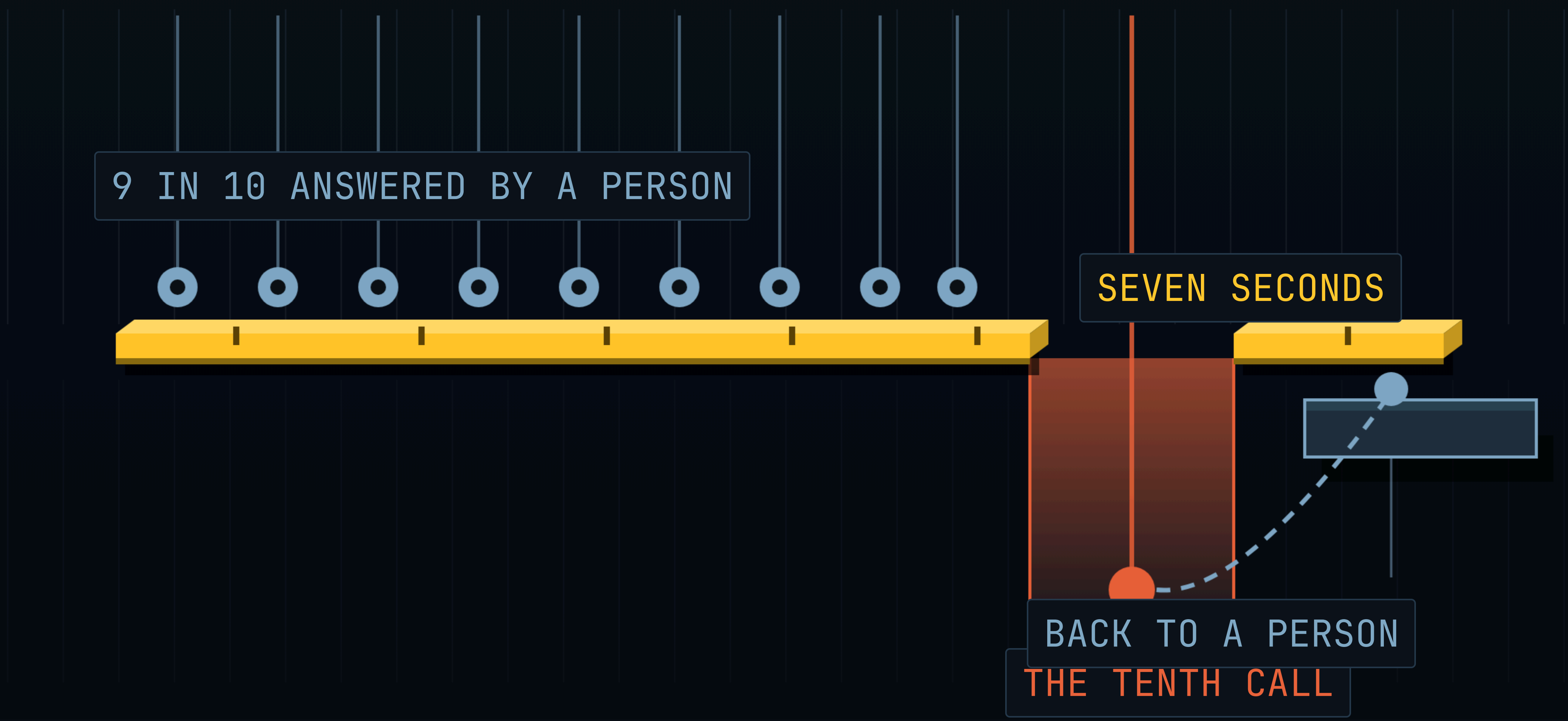
The owner's own figure, said on the podcast he co-hosts, in an episode his vendor sponsors

THE BUILD

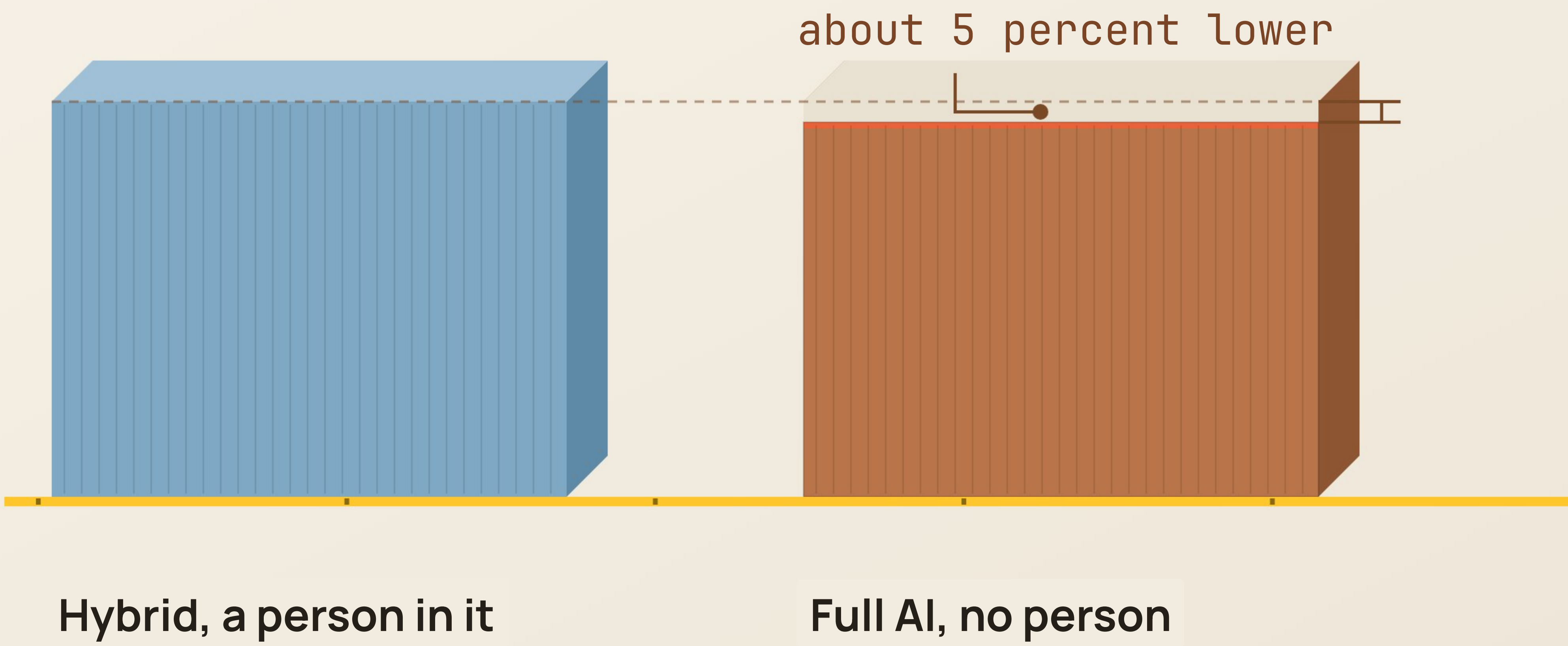
Nine calls in ten still get a person.

Wilson wanted a seven second pickup and says his people hit it on nine calls in ten. The voice platform takes the tenth call and the whole night. Per Avoca's product description it writes the job into ServiceTitan, checks technician arrival times, and hands a heated caller to a person.

The seven second pickup and the nine in ten are the owner's own figures. The ServiceTitan write and the handoff are Avoca's description of its own product.



Rung 4 on the ladder, a workflow. A person drew the steps, the machine does not pick them.



Avoca’s co-founder Tyson Chen said full AI books about 5 percent lower than the hybrid with a person in it, and they steer bigger customers to the hybrid because every point of booking rate matters.

They market always-on agents and an AI workforce. This is a workflow with a person at the handoff, their own co-founder says that version books better, and for this job it is the right thing to buy.

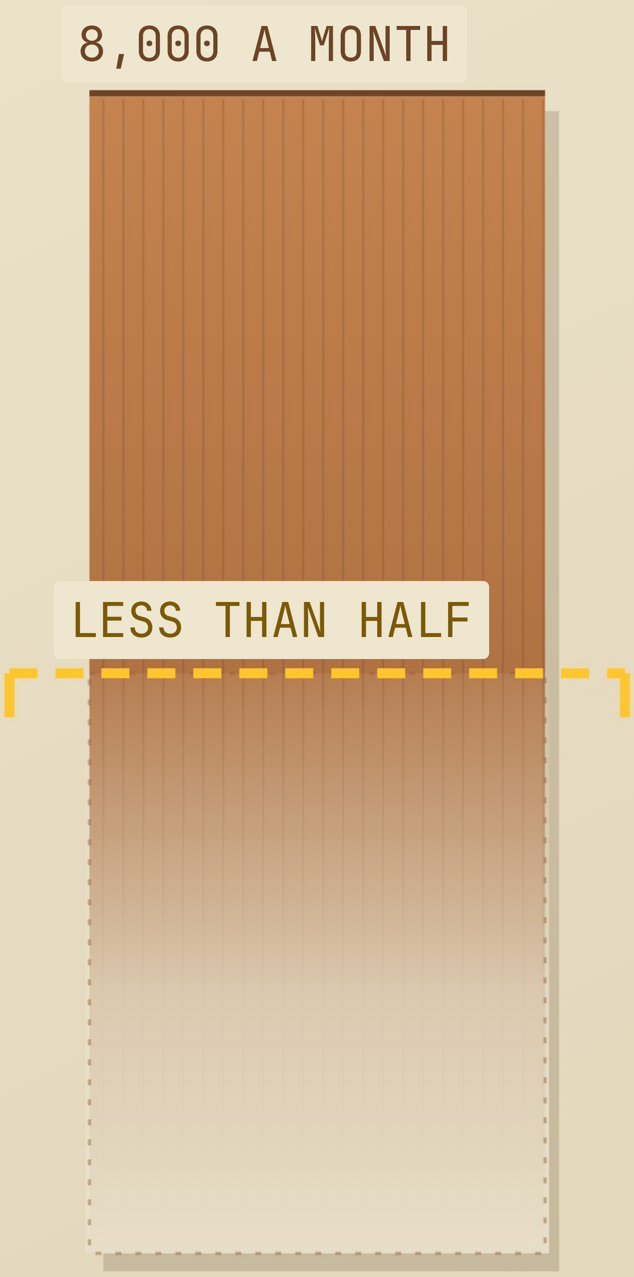
The 5 percent is Avoca's own aggregate across its customers, not a Wilson number. The marketing words are Avoca's own.

THE CURRICULUM

The seller argued against his own product's autonomy.

THE RECEIPTS

The bill dropped by more than half and the day shift held.



The invoice went away and so did the overnight and weekend shifts.

BEFORE.

8,000 dollars a month to an outside answering service, on top of their own phones staffed 24 hours.

AFTER.

Less than half of that, and the owner said out loud he did not know the exact figure.

WHERE THE CUT LANDED.

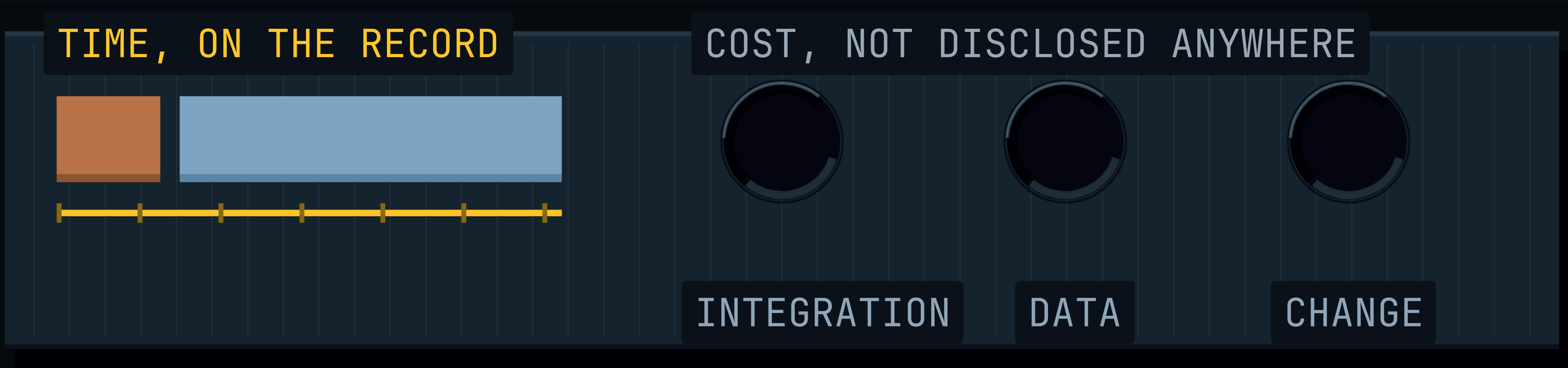
Overnight and weekend coverage, and daytime maybe tightened by two people. He credits the AI and a compensation change together, not the AI alone.

Every figure here is John Wilson's own, said on the podcast he co-hosts, in episodes his vendor sponsors. No independent account of this deployment exists.

WHAT IT TOOK

The vendor says two weeks. The owner says 90 days to get it good.

Avoca says a standard onboarding runs about two weeks and takes 3 to 4 hours of your call center manager’s time. That is the vendor’s own process, not a measurement of Wilson's. Wilson says it took about 90 days to get it working well, and he hedged it.



> **Only the subscription layer is on the record. Integration, data readiness and change cost are not disclosed anywhere, so those are the three numbers to make a vendor put in writing before you sign.**

Timing. A 90 day ramp started in mid August is working by mid November, ahead of heating season.

Somebody owns this by name, the CSR manager or the dispatch supervisor, with listening time on the calendar. A tool nobody’s job includes gets turned off in the second quarter.

The two weeks and the 3 to 4 hours are Avoca describing its standard onboarding. The 90 days is the owner's own estimate.

YOUR VERSION

Put it where Wilson has it, on nights and weekends only.

Mechanical, plumbing, restoration, property management and fuel delivery all run an after hours line. Anchorage does not get a smooth overflow curve, it gets a handful of nights a year when every marginal furnace in town quits inside six hours. Start on nights, weekends and overflow only.

MONDAY.

Pull last winter's after hours recordings and count how many became booked jobs. Free, one afternoon.

WHERE IT STOPS.

This never became an AI call center. Wilson's own people still answer nine calls in ten.

Under a dozen after hours calls on a bad night, skip the AI. Use a written intake script, a phone tree that texts the on-call tech, and a booking page that works on a phone.

Roughly 1,500 to 5,000 dollars a month here for the after hours slice. It is usage priced, so model it on January and not April.

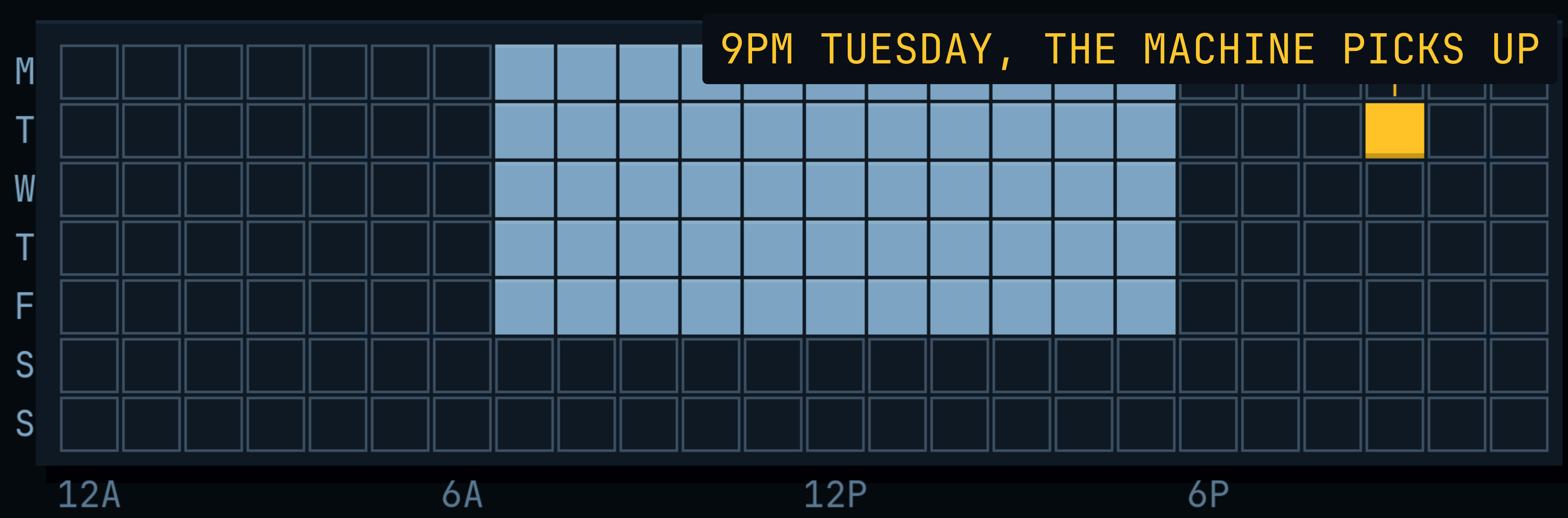
The nine in ten is the owner's own figure. The Anchorage dollar range and the cold snap pattern are our analysis, not fetched figures.

CASE FILE NO. 002

Put the machine on the shift nobody wanted.

Wilson kept his people on the day shift and stopped paying anybody to sit up all night waiting for a call. That was the whole project.

> **Save this one for the next time somebody pitches you an AI call center.**



We do this kind of analysis for Alaska businesses, free. If you want your operation looked at this way, say the word.

Sources in comments

ALASKA.AI

alaskaaihq.com